

EDITOR: Beauty in the eye of the beholder may indeed be a deterrent to crime in the streets, according to a program outlined July 21, at a meeting of the Beautify El Paso Association.

Where dramatic clean-up campaigns are undertaken in the community, where schools teach litter prevention and civic pride—there is a marked decrease in vandalism and destructiveness. A better world can very possibly begin in our own backyard.

In West Virginia, a statewide clean-up effort is credited with attracting 46 new industries to the state which created 5,000 new jobs.

Can't we do the same thing here in El Paso? Won't our citizens pitch in?

The El Paso J. C.'s have agreed to take the leadership, in cooperation with the Beautify El Paso Association, in such a program by establishing a "Clean-up Central" Headquarters, which would serve as a clearing house on the subject of weed clean-up. Citizens would be invited to call in the location of areas that need attention, or come in to offer solutions and help. The J. C. phone is 544-4637, 9 a.m. to 1 p.m.

The Beautify El Paso Association will also offer free educational material on the proper handling of trash in the home, and preparing it for city collection to avoid spilling and scattering. So much of a city's unsightliness starts in just this way.

The Beautify El Paso Association will also ask city officials to re-examine the overall matter of trash collection, and consider some of the more modern methods now used by local governments throughout the country.

The use of new odor-proof, leak-proof plastic trash bags is suggested as a convenient, more sanitary solution in keeping the curb-side parking area litter-free and attractive, and one that could possibly save the community collection time and tax dollars, as well.

The "Cash for Cans" project is proving most successful, and it is the hope of the Association that consideration and pride will go hand-in-hand with our efforts to renovate the ugly littered condition of our city, especially the city parks. A well-publicized clean-up campaign undertaken in El Paso City, can instill a self-respect in the citizens to abide by the Litter Ordinance which is being enforced in the Plaza park. — **Andy Cohen, President, Beautify El Paso Association.**